Westbrook School Committee

~ Special Meeting ~

Date: Monday, April 13, 2026
Time: 5:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 117 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1182775252
Packet: https://drive.google.com/file/d/16NwSBHBNX6VouUD3pKmEZiu9pM5x5V7_/view (Google Drive, via westbrookschools.org)

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *The full committee was present (Katy Rice remote); no student representatives attended. The committee voted 7–0 at the outset to skip minutes approval, the Superintendent's Report, and committee reports given this special meeting's narrow purpose. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

Old Business: FY27 Budget, Second & Final Reading

11.1 — Adoption of the FY27 Budget, Second and Final Reading (Roll Call Vote)

[14:29]

Discussion Summary

Before the vote, the committee heard four written public comments, all urging that two specific Westbrook Middle School instructional coach positions — literacy coach Julie Reardon and math coach Brianna Morrell — be restored to the budget rather than eliminated as proposed, continuing the same concern raised in public comment at the April 8 meeting. No board member reopened discussion of this line item, and the budget was adopted as presented without amendment.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0 by roll call (second and final reading).

Action Items

None.

Point / Counterpoint

> *"I am writing to share my disappointment and heartbreak at hearing that Julie Reardon's position...is planned to be cut from next year's school budget...Julie is more than a salary to be paid, she is an absolutely integral part of the Westbrook Middle School community."*

— Bridget Chapin, sixth-grade ELA teacher (written comment) [11:57]

> *“If, through its careful planning, the board can find a way to return the 5 through 12 literacy coach to its budget request...the district would be in a significantly better position to help our students succeed.”*

— Barbara Sloat, teacher (written comment) [2:26]

New Business

12.1 — Five-Year Copier Lease [15:32]

Discussion Summary

Director of Technology Barbara Morgan negotiated a five-year lease (instead of a purchase) with a fixed per-copy rate for the term, including maintenance, toner, and repairs at the user level — moderating future costs and reducing the district's exposure to a costly equipment failure. Already reflected in the adopted FY27 budget. Taken as a combined first-and-final reading.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0.

Action Items

None.

12.2 — Overnight Field Trip: Maine National UN Conference [19:10]

Discussion Summary

An overnight trip for six Westbrook High School students to USM Gorham for the Maine National UN Conference (May 13–15, 2026), approximately $260 per student, all inclusive. Taken as a combined first-and-final reading.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0.

Action Items

None.

Public Participation

An Individual Statement from Chair Mancuso [22:34]

Discussion Summary

During the second public-comment period, Chair Mancuso temporarily handed administration of the meeting to Erin Cavallaro and spoke from the podium in her individual capacity — as a parent, as an attorney in a leadership role addressing gender-based violence in Maine, and as an individual committee member (not an official committee position). She addressed a Maine legislative hearing scheduled the next day on a proposed act concerning school sports participation and facilities based on gender identity, stated her intent to submit individual testimony in opposition, and encouraged fellow members to do the same in their own capacities, citing Maine Integrated Youth Health Survey data on disproportionate harassment and violence faced by

LGBTQ-identifying students. No board discussion or action followed.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — individual public comment, not a committee action.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official School Committee roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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